

FormX — How we assign the front of a corner lot

One rule per jurisdiction, from each municipal or county code · 28 Bay Area jurisdictions · 2026-08-30 · **5 county records pending review (highlighted)**

Setbacks depend on which side of a lot is legally the front. For corner lots each code answers this differently, so our engine applies the rule below per jurisdiction — each verified against the cited code section. Default when a jurisdiction isn't listed: the street in the parcel's address is the front (shortest frontage if no side matches the address). The five unincorporated-county rows are new (researched 2026-08-30 directly from the county codes) and awaiting your sign-off; the 23 city rows are unchanged from the version you approved.

Jurisdiction	Rule for corner lots	Citation
Lafayette	City designates the front (falls back to default)	LMC 6-566(b)(2)
Moraga	City designates the front (falls back to default)	MMC 8.68.090
Orinda	Shortest frontage is the front	OMC 17.4.8
Contra Costa County (unincorporated) †	Every street side is a front	CCC Ord. Code 82-12.202
Fairfax	Shortest frontage is the front	TC 17.010.110(B) (Ord. 885, 11-1-2023)
Mill Valley	City designates the front (falls back to default)	MMC 20.90.030(A)(12)
Sausalito	Owner picks the front (falls back to default)	SMC 10.88
Marin County (unincorporated) †	Address street is the front	MCC 22.130.030 'Lot Line, Front'
Napa	Shortest frontage is the front	NMC 17.06.030
Napa County (unincorporated) †	Shortest frontage is the front	NCC 18.08.190 'Corner lot'
Atherton	Address street is the front	AMC 17.52.040(F)(7)
Hillsborough	Every street side is a front	HMC 17.24.020(A)
Menlo Park	Owner picks the front (falls back to default)	MPMC 16.04.405
Portola Valley	Owner picks the front (falls back to default)	PVMC 18.04.350
San Carlos	Shortest frontage is the front	SCMC 18.41.020
San Mateo	Owner picks the front (falls back to default)	SMMC 27.04.300(a)
San Mateo County (unincorporated)	Shortest frontage is the front	County zoning Def. 80
Los Altos	Shortest frontage is the front	LAMC 14.02.010 Lot line
Los Altos Hills	City designates the front (falls back to default)	LAHMC 10-1.505(c)(2)
Mountain View	Shortest frontage is the front	MVCC 36.60.27
Palo Alto	Owner picks the front (falls back to default)	PAMC 18.09.040(j)(4) corner-lot election (10 ft street side / 16 ft front)
San Jose	Shortest frontage is the front *	SJMC 20.200.700
Saratoga	Shortest frontage is the front	SMC 15-06.430(a)
Sunnyvale	Every street side is a front	SMC 19.12.260(1)(a)
Santa Clara County (unincorporated) †	Shortest frontage is the front	SCC Zoning Ordinance (County Code Title C, Appendix I) 1.30.030 'Lot lines'
Healdsburg	Shortest frontage is the front	HMC 20.28.310
Windsor	Shortest frontage is the front	Zoning Ord. 27.60.020
Sonoma County (unincorporated) †	Owner picks the front (falls back to default)	SCC 26-04-020 (Art. 04 Glossary) 'Lot Line, Front'

* San Jose exceptions: a corner lot with both frontages over 120 ft (residential) / 150 ft (commercial) gets two fronts (SJMC 20.200.670(A)); in the MS-G/MS-C main-street districts every corner lot gets two fronts (20.200.670(B)).

† NEW — county code research 2026-08-30, pending your review. These govern unincorporated land only; every parcel resolves to exactly one row here by point-in-polygon containment (incorporated place, else the county).

(falls back to default) — where the city or the owner picks the front, there is nothing for us to compute from, so the engine applies the default (address street) until a designation or election is actually made.

Judgment calls in the five new county rows

Contra Costa County — Ord. Code 82-12.202 applies setbacks to every street frontage of a corner lot, so we encode all `_fronts`; district chapters then give the "principal frontage" the full front value and the other a reduced one (e.g. R-6: 20/15 ft). "Principal

frontage" is not defined anywhere in Title 8 — we read it as the address street. Both frontages are binding street setbacks either way.

Marin County — MCC 22.130.030 makes the front "the street to which the property is addressed AND the street from which access is taken." When those two streets differ on a corner lot, the code literally creates two front lot lines; we encode `address_street` and will flag address-vs-access mismatches rather than silently picking one. Coastal zone (Title 20) has its own definitions we have not yet reviewed.

Napa County & Santa Clara County — both are shortest-frontage by code (NCC 18.08.190; SCC Zoning Ord. 1.30.030), but each carries an official escape hatch (Napa: director may designate; Santa Clara: a building-envelope tiebreak can flip to the longer line, and the zoning administrator classifies unusual lots). We apply the geometric default and surface it, since a designation is not derivable from parcel data.

Sonoma County — SCC 26-04-020 says a corner lot's front is "either one or the other" of the two street lot lines, naming no geometric test and no designating official; we read that as an owner election (falls back to default). Largely moot in magnitude: county residential tables set the street-side setback equal to the front setback. On through lots every street line is a front (26-88-040(a)).

If the five highlighted rows and the calls above look right, a ■ on Slack covers them — the city rows are unchanged from the version already approved. Full citations and reasoning are in `zoning_ordinance_links.json` and on request.